

ROBERT J. HUBA

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Cybersecurity Analyst | ICS/OT Security | SOC Operations

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Army combat veteran and cybersecurity professional with a Bachelor of Science in Cybersecurity from the University of North Carolina Wilmington. Hands-on experience in security operations, penetration testing, digital forensics, network defense, vulnerability assessment, and ICS/OT security through academic projects, cybersecurity competitions, and lab environments.

Recognized through participation in a National Security Agency (NSA) and Department of Homeland Security (DHS) National Center of Academic Excellence in Cyber Defense program. Active National Cyber League competitor and NSA Codebreaker Challenge participant with experience analyzing security incidents, conducting network investigations, and solving real-world cybersecurity challenges.

Proven leader with experience protecting critical infrastructure, sensitive assets, and personnel in high-risk environments. Former Secret security clearance holder with eligibility for reinstatement.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

B.S. in Cybersecurity — University of North Carolina Wilmington (May 2026)
Certificate of Achievement — NSA/DHS National Center of Academic Excellence in Cyber Defense (CAE-CD)
A.A.S. in Mechatronics Engineering Technology — Cape Fear Community College (Jan 2021)
Focus: Industrial Control Systems (ICS), PLCs, I/O devices, and automated systems
Certifications in Progress: CompTIA Security+ | Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Security Tools: Wireshark, Splunk, Nessus, Nmap, Burp Suite, Metasploit, Steghide, Binwalk, John the Ripper, Hashcat, Kali Linux
Security Domains: SOC Operations, Incident Response, Vulnerability Management, Digital Forensics, Penetration Testing, ICS/OT Security, Network Security, Risk Management
Operating Systems: Kali Linux, Ubuntu, Fedora, Windows, Windows Server
Programming: Python (automation & scripting), Bash
Infrastructure: Active Directory, Azure, AWS, Virtualization, LAN/WAN, ICS/SCADA, PLCs
Compliance & Governance: NIST CSF, FTC Safeguards Rule, WISP Development, Third-Party Risk Management

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Freedom Sailing | Chief Operations Officer | Leland, NC 2021 – Present

- Lead all operations for a nonprofit taking veterans, soldiers, and first responders sailing to build community and support PTSD recovery
- Developed and maintain organizational risk management framework, written information security policy (WISP), and compliance documentation
- Manage third-party vendor relationships, assessing operational risk across logistics, personnel, and equipment
- Oversee policy documentation and ensure organizational adherence to nonprofit compliance standards

IVP Forest Products | ICS Technician 2019 – 2020

- Configured and troubleshoot PLCs, I/O devices, and networked industrial systems in an active OT/ICS environment
- Resolved computer and automation issues across the production floor, maintaining operational uptime
- Applied A.A.S. in Mechatronics coursework directly to ICS challenges, bridging academic theory and production-floor practice

IVP Forest Products | Senior Machine Operator 2017 – 2019

- Operated and maintained equipment on the debarking line; identified automation inefficiencies and escalated to ICS technicians
- Demonstrated consistent reliability and technical aptitude, leading to promotion to ICS Technician role

U.S. Army | *Infantry Operations Manager & Battle NCO*

2004 – 2012

- Served as Battle NCO in the Base Defense Operations Center (BDOC) at Camp Arifjan, Kuwait — a 24/7 SOC-equivalent safeguarding 9,000+ personnel across one of the largest U.S. installations in the Middle East
- Operated and monitored surveillance systems, biometric access controls, alarm systems, and radio communications using a Secret clearance — directly analogous to modern SOC analyst work
- Coordinated emergency dispatch, Force Protection Condition (FPCON) changes, and incident response for criminal, medical, and security threats
- Maintained \$1.2M+ in weapons systems and sensitive equipment at 98% operational readiness; zero losses during entire tenure
- Led personnel through two combat deployments to Iraq; awarded Army Commendation Medal (x2) and Army Achievement Medal (x2)

CYBERSECURITY PROJECTS & COMPETITIONS

NSA Codebreaker Challenge (2023–2025)

- Competed in NSA's flagship challenge; solved real-world scenarios in reverse engineering, network forensics, and exploit development

National Cyber League (NCL) — 2024–2025

- Competed in network traffic analysis, OSINT, password auditing, malware analysis, and log analysis events

Steganography & Digital Forensics Research

- Led investigation into malware concealed within digital images; built an analysis framework using Steghide, Binwalk, and custom Python tooling

Kali Linux Home Lab & Python Port Scanner

- Built and maintain a professional pentest lab (Kali, Windows Server, Active Directory); developed a multithreaded Python port scanner for network reconnaissance

Enterprise Secure Network Design (UNCW Capstone)

- Designed full enterprise network architecture with firewall rules, IDS/IPS placement, network segmentation, and endpoint security controls

AWARDS & DISTINCTIONS

Army Commendation Medal (x2) | Army Achievement Medal (x2) | Combat Infantry Badge | Iraqi Campaign Medal with 2 Campaign Stars